

Extensions of Quandles with Stabilizing Orbit Series

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October 10, 2026

Working preprint

Abstract

Let the class $\mathcal{OS}$ consist of quandles in which every orbit series stabilizes after finitely many steps. We prove that $\mathcal{OS}$ is closed under extensions: if the quotient and every full fibre of an epimorphism belong to $\mathcal{OS}$, then the original quandle does as well. No common bound on the depths of the fibres is required. The key ingredient is a group identity for relative commutator series of a single automorphism. If $N \trianglelefteq L$, $\phi(N) = N$, and $[L/N, \bar{\phi}] = L/N$, then the series $R_0 = N$, $R_{i+1} = [R_i, \phi]$ and $D_0 = L$, $D_{i+1} = [D_i, \phi]$ satisfy $D_i = R_i D_{i+1}$. The passage to quandles proceeds through conjugacy classes and coverings and does not require injectivity of the map that assigns to each element its left translation. We also show that the class $\mathcal{OS}_\omega = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} \mathcal{OS}_n$ is not closed under extensions. Thus we answer both parts of Question 5.7 of Bonatto–Crans–Nasybullov–Whitney.

Keywords: quandle, orbit series, extension, subnormal subgroup, group automorphism.

1 Introduction and main results

Orbit series of quandles, the classes $\mathcal{OS}$, $\mathcal{OS}_n$, $t\mathcal{OS}$, $t\mathcal{OS}_n$, and their unions over finite indices were introduced in [1, Section 4.1]. Question 5.7 of that paper asks whether $\mathcal{OS}$ and $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$ are closed under extensions. The numbering of the question and results from [1] used below follows arXiv version v3, dated August 18, 2020.

In arXiv versions v1 and v2 of [1], Corollary 5.6 already asserted extension closure of both $\mathcal{OS}$ and $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$. Version v3 restricts that corollary to $t\mathcal{OS}$ and $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega$ and adds Question 5.7. We record this history of the arXiv texts without inferring a reason for the change or claiming priority for the qualitative $\mathcal{OS}$ statement.

It is essential to distinguish two conditions. In the class $\mathcal{OS}$, each individual orbit series must stabilize, but the number of steps may depend on the series. In the class $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$, a single finite bound must work for all series of a given quandle. The definition of an extension does not require a common bound across different full fibres.

Theorem 1.1. *Let $\pi : Q \twoheadrightarrow B$ be an epimorphism of quandles. If $B \in \mathcal{OS}$ and $\pi^{-1}(b) \in \mathcal{OS}$ for every $b \in B$, then $Q \in \mathcal{OS}$. Consequently, the class $\mathcal{OS}$ is closed under extensions.*

Proposition 1.2. *The class $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$ is not closed under extensions. A counterexample can be chosen with a trivial base and finite full fibres.*

Theorem 1.1 is proved in Section 5. Its group-theoretic core, Theorem 3.2, states that stabilization of a relative commutator series on a normal subgroup lifts to the whole group without

increasing the number of steps, provided the quotient is perfect relative to the automorphism under consideration. The proof uses the elementary fact that a subnormal subgroup of finite defect that normally generates a group must equal that group. Proposition 1.2 follows from the disjoint union of dihedral quandles in Example 4.2 of [1], after considering the projection onto the summand index.

The definitions of orbit-series classes and extensions follow [1]; the term “covering” is used in the sense of [2], translated to the left convention. All auxiliary group and quandle lemmas, including the required property of coverings, are proved below. For the negative example, we also give a direct computation of orbit series.

2 Definitions and auxiliary lemmas

Definition 2.1. A *quandle* is a nonempty set Q with an operation $\triangleright$ satisfying

$$x \triangleright x = x, \quad L_x : y \mapsto x \triangleright y \text{ is bijective,} \quad x \triangleright (y \triangleright z) = (x \triangleright y) \triangleright (x \triangleright z).$$

A subquandle is closed under the operation and inverse left translations. The group $\text{Inn}(Q) = \langle L_x : x \in Q \rangle$ is called the inner automorphism group of the quandle. We write $\text{Orb}(x, Q)$ for the orbit of x . A quandle is connected if this group acts transitively; it is trivial if $x \triangleright y = y$ for all x, y .

A quandle homomorphism preserves the operation; an epimorphism here and below means a surjective homomorphism.

By choosing $x_i \in Q_i$ successively, we construct an *orbit series*

$$Q_0 = Q, \quad Q_{i+1} = \text{Orb}(x_i, Q_i).$$

The class $\mathcal{OS}$ consists of quandles such that every orbit series has some $m \geq 0$ with $Q_m = Q_{m+1}$. The class $\mathcal{OS}_n$, for $n \geq 1$, is defined by requiring that such an $m \leq n$ can be chosen for every series. Set $\mathcal{OS}_\omega = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} \mathcal{OS}_n$. The stable term of a series is connected, since $Q_m = \text{Orb}(x_m, Q_m)$. The trivializing classes $t\mathcal{OS}$ and $t\mathcal{OS}_n$ are defined by requiring that a singleton quandle be reached, respectively, in finitely many steps or no later than step n . Set $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} t\mathcal{OS}_n$.

By an *extension* we mean an epimorphism $\pi : Q \twoheadrightarrow B$; its full fibres are $F_b = \pi^{-1}(b)$. Equivalently, one considers the quotient Q/α and all full congruence classes of $\alpha = \ker \pi$, as in [1, Section 2.2].

Lemma 2.2. An epimorphism $p : E \twoheadrightarrow C$ induces an epimorphism $\text{Inn}(E) \twoheadrightarrow \text{Inn}(C)$ sending L_x to $L_{p(x)}$, and

$$p(\text{Orb}(x, E)) = \text{Orb}(p(x), C).$$

In particular, images of orbit series are orbit series, and the class $\mathcal{OS}$ is closed under epimorphic images.

Proof. The identity $pL_x = L_{p(x)}p$ also holds for inverse translations. If a word in translations acts trivially on E , then the corresponding word acts trivially on C , since p is surjective. This makes the group map well-defined, and its surjectivity follows by lifting generators. The equality of orbits follows. For an arbitrary subquandle, the same argument applies after restricting the map to that subquandle and taking its image as the codomain.

Any orbit series in C can be lifted successively to a series in E : each next anchor can be lifted to the current term, which maps surjectively onto the corresponding term in C . Stabilization of the lifted series implies stabilization of the original one. $\square$

Lemma 2.3. If $F \in \mathcal{OS}$ and a nonempty subquandle $S \subseteq F$ is invariant under $\text{Inn}(F)$, then $S \in \mathcal{OS}$.

Proof. Take any series $S = S_0 \supseteq S_1 \supseteq \dots$ with anchors $x_j \in S_j$. Using the same anchors, define $F_0 = F$, $F_{j+1} = \text{Orb}(x_j, F_j)$. We obtain by induction

$$F_j \supseteq S_j \supseteq F_{j+1}, \quad S_j \text{ is invariant under } \text{Inn}(F_j).$$

Indeed, invariance of S_j implies $F_{j+1} \subseteq S_j$, while $S_j \subseteq F_j$ implies $S_{j+1} \subseteq F_{j+1}$. Since S_{j+1} is an orbit in S_j , and $F_{j+1} \subseteq S_j$, translations by elements of F_{j+1} and their inverses preserve S_{j+1} . This gives the next step.

The series F_j stabilizes: $F_m = F_{m+1} = \text{Orb}(x_m, F_m)$. The inclusions give $S_m = F_m$; connectedness of F_m implies $S_{m+1} = S_m$. $\square$

Remark 2.4. In Lemma 2.3, the invariance assumption is essential. We do not use inheritance of $\mathcal{OS}$ by arbitrary subquandles; in general, this fails by [1, Example 5.3].

Lemma 2.5. *Suppose all full fibres of an epimorphism $\pi : Q \twoheadrightarrow B$ belong to $\mathcal{OS}$, and let Q_i be an orbit series in Q . Then every nonempty slice $Q_i \cap F_b$ belongs to $\mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. If $S_i = Q_i \cap F_b \neq \emptyset$, then all $S_j = Q_j \cap F_b$, $0 \leq j \leq i$, are nonempty. For $j < i$ and $y \in S_j$, the translations $L_y^{\pm 1}$ preserve both the orbit Q_{j+1} in Q_j and the fibre F_b : on the base, $L_b^{\pm 1}$ fix b . Thus S_{j+1} is invariant under $\text{Inn}(S_j)$. Starting with $S_0 = F_b$, we successively apply Lemma 2.3 up to index i . Nonemptiness of later slices is not required. $\square$

Lemma 2.6. *An epimorphism onto a trivial quandle with full fibres in $\mathcal{OS}$ has its domain in $\mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. The first orbit of any series lies in a single full fibre. As an orbit under the inner group of the domain, it is invariant under the inner group of that fibre. Apply Lemma 2.3; the remaining series stabilizes. $\square$

Definition 2.7. An epimorphism $p : E \twoheadrightarrow C$ is called a *covering* if

$$p(x) = p(y) \implies L_x^E = L_y^E.$$

This is [2, Definition 2.32, arXiv v3], translated from the right convention to the left convention.

Lemma 2.8. *If $p : E \twoheadrightarrow C$ is a covering and $C \in \mathcal{OS}$, then $E \in \mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. For a series E_i , the images $C_i = p(E_i)$ stabilize at a connected subquandle C_* . On the corresponding tail, all $E_i \twoheadrightarrow C_*$. Consider the groups of global permutations of the set E

$$\Gamma_i = \langle L_x^E : x \in E_i \rangle.$$

Their generating sets are the same on the tail: a translation depends only on $p(x)$, and the image sets $p(E_i) = C_*$ coincide. Denote the common group by Γ . Each E_i is preserved by this group, and its restrictions generate $\text{Inn}(E_i)$. Therefore, E_{i+1} is a Γ -orbit; the next anchor lies in this same orbit, and $E_{i+2} = E_{i+1}$. $\square$

3 Lifting a relative commutator series

For a group, write $x^y = y^{-1}xy$. The ordinary commutator is $[x, y] = x^{-1}y^{-1}xy$, $H' = [H, H]$ is the commutator subgroup, and $C_H(h) = \{q \in H : qh = hq\}$ is the centralizer. The normal closure of a subgroup is the smallest normal subgroup containing it. If $\phi \in \text{Aut}(L)$ and $X \leq L$ satisfies $\phi(X) = X$, set

$$[X, \phi] = \langle x^{-1}\phi(x) : x \in X \rangle.$$

The notation denotes the subgroup generated by these elements, not merely the set of values.

Lemma 3.1. *Let A be subnormal in B with finite defect. If $\langle A^B \rangle = B$, then $A = B$.*

Proof. Choose a finite chain $A = A_0 \trianglelefteq A_1 \trianglelefteq \cdots \trianglelefteq A_m = B$. If $m = 0$, there is nothing to prove. Otherwise, the normal subgroup A_{m-1} of B contains A , and hence contains its normal closure, which is B . Thus $A_{m-1} = B$. Removing the last terms successively gives $A = B$. $\square$

Theorem 3.2. *Let $N \trianglelefteq L$, $\phi \in \text{Aut}(L)$, $\phi(N) = N$, and suppose the induced automorphism $\bar{\phi}$ satisfies $[L/N, \bar{\phi}] = L/N$. Define*

$$R_0 = N, \quad R_{i+1} = [R_i, \phi], \quad D_0 = L, \quad D_{i+1} = [D_i, \phi].$$

Then, for every $i \geq 0$,

$$D_i = R_i D_{i+1}. \tag{1}$$

In particular,

$$R_r = R_{r+1} \implies D_r = D_{r+1} \quad (r \geq 0).$$

Proof. Write $\delta(x) = x^{-1}\phi(x)$. We have

$$\delta(xy) = \delta(x)^y \delta(y), \quad \delta(x)^y = \delta(xy) \delta(y)^{-1}. \tag{2}$$

It follows that $[X, \phi] \trianglelefteq X$ for every ϕ -invariant X . The identity $\phi(\delta(x)) = \delta(\phi(x))$ shows ϕ -invariance of this subgroup. The series R_i, D_i are descending; monotonicity of the operation $X \mapsto [X, \phi]$ gives $R_i \leq D_i$. Moreover, R_i is subnormal in D_i : intersect the finite chain

$$R_i \trianglelefteq R_{i-1} \trianglelefteq \cdots \trianglelefteq N \trianglelefteq L$$

with D_i . Normality of consecutive terms is preserved; the endpoints of the resulting chain are R_i and D_i .

We prove (1) by induction. For $i = 0$, the image of D_1 in L/N is the whole quotient, so $L = ND_1$. Let $i \geq 1$ and suppose $D_{i-1} = R_{i-1}D_i$. Set $M_i = \langle R_i^{D_i} \rangle$. Every $x \in D_{i-1}$ has the form rd , where $r \in R_{i-1}$ and $d \in D_i$. By (2),

$$\delta(x) = \delta(r)^d \delta(d) \in M_i D_{i+1}.$$

Since $D_{i+1} \trianglelefteq D_i$, the right-hand side is a subgroup. All generators of $D_i = [D_{i-1}, \phi]$ lie in it, and the reverse inclusion is immediate. Thus

$$D_i = M_i D_{i+1}.$$

The image of R_i in D_i/D_{i+1} is subnormal of finite defect and normally generates this quotient. By Lemma 3.1, it is the entire quotient, which gives (1) and completes the induction.

If $R_r = R_{r+1}$, then $R_r = [R_r, \phi] \leq [D_r, \phi] = D_{r+1}$. Now (1) gives $D_r = D_{r+1}$. $\square$

Remark 3.3. Theorem 3.2 assumes no finiteness, solvability, splitting, or finite order of the automorphism. The terms R_i need not be normal in all of L ; only their subnormality in D_i is used.

Remark 3.4. More generally, let $N \trianglelefteq L$, let $A \leq \text{Aut}(L)$ preserve N , and suppose $[L/N, A] = L/N$, where $[X, A] = \langle x^{-1}a(x) : x \in X, a \in A \rangle$. Define $R_0 = N$, $D_0 = L$, $R_{i+1} = [R_i, A]$, and $D_{i+1} = [D_i, A]$. The proof of Theorem 3.2 gives $D_i = R_i D_{i+1}$ and the same stabilization implication. Indeed, with $\delta_a(x) = x^{-1}a(x)$,

$$\delta_a(xy) = \delta_a(x)^y \delta_a(y), \quad b(\delta_a(x)) = \delta_{bab^{-1}}(b(x)) \quad (a, b \in A).$$

These identities give normality in X and A -invariance of $[X, A]$ when X is A -invariant. The same finite subnormal chains and induction with $M_i = \langle R_i^{D_i} \rangle$ apply: for $x = rd$, every $\delta_a(x)$ lies in $M_i D_{i+1}$. Thus $D_i = M_i D_{i+1}$, and Lemma 3.1 again gives $D_i = R_i D_{i+1}$.

A known case of this operator version is the split inner action: $L = N \rtimes K$, $A = \text{Inn}(L)$, and K perfect. The induced action on $L/N \cong K$ is $\text{Inn}(K)$, so $[K, \text{Inn}(K)] = [K, K] = K$. Here $D_i = \gamma_{i+1}(L)$ and $R_i = \gamma_{i+1}^K(N)$, with $\gamma_1^K(N) = N$ and $\gamma_{j+1}^K(N) = [L, \gamma_j^K(N)]$. The known decomposition

$$\gamma_j(L) = \gamma_j^K(N) \rtimes \gamma_j(K)$$

[3, Proposition–Definition 1.29 and Proposition 1.33], [4, Theorem 1.2, arXiv v1] gives $D_i = R_i \rtimes K = R_i D_{i+1}$. This identifies an existing split-inner case; it does not establish priority for arbitrary operator-perfect quotients or nonsplit extensions. Operator-perfectness of a quotient does not require that quotient group to be perfect in the ordinary sense.

4 Extensions of conjugacy classes

We regard the class $c^K = \{g^{-1}cg : g \in K\}$ as a quandle with operation $a \triangleright b = aba^{-1}$. This convention corresponds to Conj_{-1} in [1].

Lemma 4.1. *For $c \in K$, set $K_0 = K$, $K_{j+1} = \langle c^{K_j} \rangle$. The quandle c^K belongs to $\mathcal{OS}$ if and only if the subgroup series K_j stabilizes after finitely many steps.*

Proof. Set $Y_j = c^{K_j}$. Then $K_{j+1} \trianglelefteq K_j$ and $Y_{j+1} = \text{Orb}(c, Y_j)$, so Y_j is a principal orbit series with constant anchor c . Equality $K_j = K_{j+1}$ gives $Y_j = Y_{j+1}$, while equality $Y_j = Y_{j+1}$ gives $K_{j+1} = K_{j+2}$.

We show that stabilization of the principal series is sufficient. Any finite initial segment of an arbitrary orbit series can be conjugated into the form Y_j . If the first terms have already been put in this form, the next anchor has the form c^g , where $g \in K_j$. Conjugation by g^{-1} sends it to c and preserves all previous Y_k , for $k \leq j$, since $K_j \leq K_k$. It sends the next orbit to Y_{j+1} . Thus, if $Y_m = Y_{m+1}$, normalization through the anchor of index m gives equality of the corresponding terms in any series. The converse follows from stabilization of the principal series. $\square$

Lemma 4.2. *Let $\sigma : G \twoheadrightarrow H$, $h = \sigma(c)$, $N = \ker \sigma$, $P = \sigma^{-1}(C_H(h))$. If the full fibre c^P of the epimorphism $c^G \rightarrow h^H$ belongs to $\mathcal{OS}$, then $c^N \in \mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. Set $V = N\langle c \rangle = \sigma^{-1}(\langle h \rangle)$. Since $\langle h \rangle$ is central in $C_H(h)$, we have $V \trianglelefteq P$. Every element of c^P maps to h , so $\langle c^P \rangle \leq V$. Moreover, $c^V = c^N$: every element of $V = \langle c \rangle N$ can be written as $c^k n$, and $c^{c^k n} = c^n$. Normality of N ensures both orders of decomposition of V .

For $A_0 = P$, $B_0 = V$, and

$$A_{j+1} = \langle c^{A_j} \rangle, \quad B_{j+1} = \langle c^{B_j} \rangle$$

monotonicity gives, by induction,

$$A_{j+1} \leq B_j \leq A_j \quad (j \geq 0).$$

The base case is $A_1 \leq V \leq P$. Applying the monotone operator to the two inclusions gives the next two inclusions. If $A_m = A_{m+1} = T$, then $A_{m+2} = T$ as well; squeezing gives $B_m = B_{m+1} = T$. We now apply Lemma 4.1. $\square$

Proposition 4.3. *Let $\sigma : G \twoheadrightarrow H$, $h = \sigma(c)$, and $H = \langle h^H \rangle$. If the full fibre c^P , where $P = \sigma^{-1}(C_H(h))$, belongs to $\mathcal{OS}$, then $c^G \in \mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. Let H' be the commutator subgroup of H , $N = \ker \sigma$, $L = \sigma^{-1}(H')$. Normal generation of H by h implies

$$H = H'\langle h \rangle, \quad G = L\langle c \rangle.$$

The restriction $\sigma|_L$ maps onto H' and $L/N \cong H'$. Set $\phi(l) = c^{-1}lc$, $\psi(q) = h^{-1}qh$. Since $N = \ker \sigma$, we have $N \trianglelefteq L$ and $\phi(N) = N$. The induced automorphism $\bar{\phi}$ corresponds to ψ .

H' is characteristic in H , hence invariant under ψ . The subgroup $J = [H', \psi]$ is normal in H' and invariant under h , hence normal in H . In H/J , the image of h is central and normally generates the whole quotient. The quotient is cyclic; hence $H' \leq J$, that is,

$$[H', \psi] = H'. \quad (3)$$

Introduce auxiliary groups with infinite cyclic generators u, v :

$$\tilde{G} = L \rtimes_{\phi} \langle u \rangle, \quad \tilde{H} = H' \rtimes_{\psi} \langle v \rangle, \quad u^{-1}lu = \phi(l), \quad v^{-1}qv = \psi(q).$$

The following epimorphisms are well-defined:

$$\tilde{\sigma}(lu^k) = \sigma(l)v^k, \quad \rho_G(lu^k) = lc^k, \quad \rho_H(qv^k) = qh^k.$$

Indeed, $\sigma(\phi(l)) = \psi(\sigma(l))$ and $c^{-1}lc = \phi(l)$, $h^{-1}qh = \psi(q)$, so the defining relations are preserved. Surjectivity follows from $\sigma(L) = H'$, $G = L\langle c \rangle$ and $H = H'\langle h \rangle$. The first map has kernel N , and the other maps are compatible with σ and $\tilde{\sigma}$. The restrictions of ρ_G, ρ_H induce quandle isomorphisms

$$u^{\tilde{G}} \cong c^G, \quad v^{\tilde{H}} \cong h^H. \quad (4)$$

Indeed, surjectivity of the group maps allows any conjugating element to be lifted. Every element of $u^{\tilde{G}}$ has $\mathbb{Z}$ -coordinate 1, and on Lu , the map ρ_G is injective: $lc = l'c$ implies $l = l'$. The argument for the base is the same. The isomorphisms in (4) are compatible with the epimorphisms of quandles and preserve all their full fibres; we also have $u^N \cong c^N$.

For a ϕ -invariant $X \leq L$, the normal closure of u in $X \rtimes_{\phi} \langle u \rangle$ is

$$[X, \phi] \rtimes \langle u \rangle. \quad (5)$$

It contains u and all $x^{-1}\phi(x) = (u^x)^{-1}u$. Conversely, the subgroup on the right is normal: $[X, \phi] \leq X$, it is invariant under u , and on $X/[X, \phi]$, the action of u is trivial. Consequently, it contains the normal closure of u .

By Lemma 4.2, $c^N \in \mathcal{OS}$, hence $u^N \in \mathcal{OS}$. Also, $u^{N \rtimes \langle u \rangle} = u^N$. By (5), the series of normal closures of u in this group has terms $R_i \rtimes \langle u \rangle$, where $R_0 = N$, $R_{i+1} = [R_i, \phi]$. Lemma 4.1 gives stabilization of R_i . Condition (3) allows us to apply Theorem 3.2; the global series $D_0 = L$, $D_{i+1} = [D_i, \phi]$ stabilizes. By (5), the series of normal closures of u in $\tilde{G}$ stabilizes as well. Thus $u^{\tilde{G}} \in \mathcal{OS}$, and (4) gives $c^G \in \mathcal{OS}$. $\square$

Remark 4.4. The auxiliary semidirect product is not an assumption that the original σ splits. The element c may have finite order; the generator u is chosen to have infinite order only in the auxiliary group.

5 Proof of extension closure for arbitrary quandles

Lemma 5.1. *Let $\pi : E \twoheadrightarrow C$ be an epimorphism, where C is connected and all full fibres $F_a = \pi^{-1}(a)$ belong to $\mathcal{OS}$. Then $E \in \mathcal{OS}$.*

Proof. Choose an arbitrary first orbit $O = \text{Orb}(x, E)$. By Lemma 2.2, $\pi(O) = C$, and by Lemma 2.5, $O \cap F_a \in \mathcal{OS}$ for every $a \in C$.

Set $G = \text{Inn}(E)$, $H = \text{Inn}(C)$, $c = L_x^E$, $h = L_{\pi(x)}^C$. The epimorphism π induces $\sigma : G \twoheadrightarrow H$. The map $\lambda_E(y) = L_y^E$ is a homomorphism of quandles, since

$$L_{y \triangleright z}^E = L_y^E L_z^E (L_y^E)^{-1}.$$

Equivariance of this map gives $\lambda_E(O) = c^G$. Connectedness of C similarly gives

$$\{L_a^C : a \in C\} = h^H, \quad H = \langle h^H \rangle.$$

Write $b = \pi(x)$ and

$$T = \{a \in C : L_a^C = L_b^C\}, \quad S = O \cap \pi^{-1}(T).$$

The quandle T is trivial: for $a, d \in T$, $a \triangleright d = L_a^C(d) = L_d^C(d) = d$. The map $S \rightarrow T$ has full fibres $O \cap F_a \in \mathcal{OS}$; by Lemma 2.6, $S \in \mathcal{OS}$.

The full fibre of $c^G \rightarrow h^H$ over h is exactly $\lambda_E(S)$. Indeed, the image of an element L_y^E , with $y \in O$, is h if and only if $L_{\pi(y)}^C = L_b^C$. By Lemma 2.2, this fibre belongs to $\mathcal{OS}$. Proposition 4.3 gives $c^G \in \mathcal{OS}$.

The epimorphism $\lambda_E|_O : O \rightarrow c^G$ is a covering: equality of global translations $L_y^E = L_z^E$ implies equality of their restrictions $L_y^O = L_z^O$. By Lemma 2.8, $O \in \mathcal{OS}$. This holds for every first orbit in E ; therefore, every orbit series in E stabilizes. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Take an arbitrary series Q_i in Q . The images $B_i = \pi(Q_i)$ form an orbit series in B and from some index n onward are all equal to a connected subquandle B_* . The restriction $Q_n \rightarrow B_*$ has full fibres $Q_n \cap F_b \in \mathcal{OS}$ by Lemma 2.5. Applying Lemma 5.1, we obtain $Q_n \in \mathcal{OS}$. Therefore the chosen tail of the series stabilizes. Since the original series was arbitrary, $Q \in \mathcal{OS}$. $\square$

Remark 5.2. A quandle is called *faithful* if $y \mapsto L_y$ is injective [1, Section 2.2]. The map $y \mapsto L_y$ need not be injective. Thus the proof also covers nonfaithful quandles. No common finite bound on the depths of the full fibres is needed. The bound in Theorem 3.2 concerns group series; an optimal quantitative bound for arbitrary quandles is not established in this work.

6 Negative answer for $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$

Proof of Proposition 1.2. Let D_{2^r} be the dihedral quandle on $\mathbb{Z}/2^r\mathbb{Z}$ with operation $a \triangleright b = 2a - b$. Consider the disjoint union

$$Q = \bigsqcup_{r \geq 1} D_{2^r},$$

where, for elements in different summands, $x \triangleright y = y$. This is the quandle in [1, Example 4.2]. The projection $\pi : Q \rightarrow T_{\mathbb{N}_{\geq 1}}$ onto the summand index is an epimorphism to a trivial quandle. Its full fibres are finite D_{2^r} , so they all belong to $\mathcal{OS}_\omega$; the base belongs to $\mathcal{OS}_1$.

The depths in the domain are unbounded. Choose zero in the summand D_{2^r} and use the constant anchor 0. The inner orbits of an even dihedral quandle are the parity classes: $L_a L_b$ is translation by $2(a - b)$. Elements of the other summands act trivially. Thus the series in Q has the form

$$Q_0 = Q, \quad Q_i = 2^i \mathbb{Z}/2^r \mathbb{Z} \quad (1 \leq i \leq r), \quad Q_r = Q_{r+1} = \{0\}.$$

Every step up to r is strict. For any proposed common bound n , choose $r > n$; then $Q \notin \mathcal{OS}_n$. Consequently, $Q \notin \mathcal{OS}_\omega$.

For any coset $S = a + 2^j \mathbb{Z}/2^r \mathbb{Z}$ and $x \in S$, we have

$$\text{Orb}(x, S) = x + 2^{j+1} \mathbb{Z}/2^r \mathbb{Z}.$$

Indeed, the values $L_y(x) = 2y - x$ for $y \in S$ run through the entire indicated coset, which is invariant under all $L_y^{\pm 1}$. Therefore every individual series, after its first step, lies in one summand and, for any subsequent choice of anchors, reaches a singleton quandle by step r at the latest. Hence $Q \in t\mathcal{OS} \subseteq \mathcal{OS}$, in agreement with Theorem 1.1. $\square$

Remark 6.1. Each fibre in the last example has finite depth, but there is no common index for all fibres. If one defines a different notion of closure requiring a common bound on depths, this example does not refute it. The same example also shows that the class $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} t\mathcal{OS}_n$ is

not closed under extensions: the fibres belong to $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega$, while the domain does not. Consequently, the assertion that $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega$ is closed under extensions in [1, Corollary 5.6, arXiv v1–v3] is false for the definition of extension in its Section 2.2, which does not require a uniform bound across fibres. [1, Lemma 5.5, arXiv v3] assumes a single fixed index m for all full fibres and is not contradicted by this example. This hypothesis must be retained to deduce membership in $t\mathcal{OS}_\omega$ from that lemma.

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